STONES & ANCHORS MEN'S BIBLE STUDY

Week 1

Servant Leadership

Strength under God, humility before God, and leadership that serves rather than controls.

RESOURCES DRAFT FOR REVIEW

WEEK 1 FRAME

The Lion and the Lamb

*Biblical leadership must hold **authority** and **humility** together. When one side is missing, strength becomes control or gentleness becomes passivity.*

AUTHORITY · COURAGE · KINGSHIP

Lion

Revelation 5:5
Jesus is the **Lion of Judah**.

Isaiah 31:4
The Lord is compared to a lion **unmoved by opposition**.

Revelation 19:15–16
Christ comes in judgment and rule as **King of kings**.

HUMILITY · SACRIFICE · SURRENDER

Lamb

John 1:29
Jesus is the **Lamb of God** who takes away sin.

Isaiah 53:7
The suffering servant is led **like a lamb**.

1 Peter 1:18–19
We are redeemed by the **precious blood of Christ**, like a spotless lamb.

Main point: Authority without humility becomes control. Humility without authority becomes dormancy. Christ shows both power and surrender in perfect balance.

Servants Belong to the House

A biblical servant is not an isolated worker. He lives from the household of the Master.

Identity, provision, and covering are tied to whose house he belongs to, not to how independent he appears.

WHAT THIS MEANS

In the ancient world, a servant was part of the master's *oikos*, or household. He was shaped by the order of that house, protected by its reputation, and sustained by its resources. Servanthood began with belonging before it moved into task.

NEW TESTAMENT ANCHORS

Ephesians 2:19
You are no longer strangers, but members of the **household of God**.

Galatians 4:7
In Christ, you are no longer a slave, but a **son and heir**.

Study takeaway: Kingdom leadership starts by settling the question of ownership. Before a man leads well, he must know whose house he is under and whose provision he trusts.

Servants Carry the Master's Authority

A trusted servant does not merely represent the master's words. He carries the weight of the master's **name** and moves in the master's **authority**.

WHAT THIS MEANS

In biblical leadership, speaking on God's behalf is only half the picture. Servants are also called to obey, act, and move in faith. Boldness is not self-generated swagger; it is the confidence that comes from carrying the assignment of the One who sent you.

Faith becomes visible when it moves. A man may claim belief all day, but leadership begins when belief is translated into obedient action.

VERSES

2 Timothy 1:7
God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of **power**, love, and a sound mind.

James 2:17
Faith without works is dead.

John 20:21
As the Father has sent Me, **even so I am sending you**.

Acts 4:29
Grant Your servants to continue to speak Your word with **all boldness**.

Main takeaway
Biblical authority is never passive. It speaks, acts, and obeys.

Dependency Beats Autonomy

SURRENDERED WILL

The core of biblical servanthood is not simply doing assigned tasks. It is yielding personal rule. A servant brings his desires, plans, and instincts into alignment with the purpose of the Master.

John 15:5
Apart from Me, **you can do nothing**.

Romans 12:1
Present your bodies as a **living sacrifice** to God.

Here I am

Hineni

A posture of being **available**, **attentive**, and **ready** before God.

LEADERSHIP TAKEAWAY

Biblical leadership is not radical self-direction. It is radical availability to God. The strongest men are not those who insist on autonomy, but those who can say yes to God's direction quickly, fully, and without bargaining.

Galatians 2:20
It is no longer I who live, but **Christ who lives in me**.

Philippians 2:13
God works in you both **to will and to work** for His good pleasure.

Devotion Is a Chosen Bond

The bondservant picture says devotion can become a willing bond, not merely an imposed duty.

Leadership under Jesus is a conscious choice to let Him write the story, direct the house, and lead us from glory unto even greater glory. What we surrender to Him is never wasted; it becomes seed in a kingdom economy that outlasts self-made ambition.

VERSES

2 Corinthians 9:6–7
Whoever sows sparingly reaps sparingly, and whoever sows bountifully reaps bountifully. God loves a cheerful giver.

Galatians 6:7–9
Whatever a man sows, that will he also reap. Do not grow weary in doing good.

Romans 12:11
Do not be slothful in zeal, but be **fervent in spirit**, serving the Lord.

Colossians 3:23–24
Work heartily, as for the Lord and not for men, knowing you are **serving the Lord Christ**.

Main takeaway: Devotion is costly, but the return on surrender is greater than anything a self-directed life can produce. Servanthood chooses the Master's house because it trusts the Master's character.

Vision Sees the Build Before the Start

A leader sees the finished build before the first shovel hits the dirt.

Vision gives the team a destination, a reason for the work, and a way to measure whether the build is on course. Without it, men become reactive, scattered, and easy to discourage.

LEADERSHIP IMPLICATION

Strategic thinking is not abstract dreaming. It is the discipline of seeing where the work must go, anticipating obstacles before they arrive, and communicating the path clearly enough that others can move with confidence.

Proverbs 29:18
Where there is no vision, the people perish.

Hebrews 11:1
Faith is the assurance of things **hoped for** and the conviction of things not seen.

Philippians 3:13–14
Forgetting what lies behind, **press on toward the goal**.

Decisiveness Breaks Paralysis

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

A leader gathers what he needs, then makes the call.

Endless hesitation drains momentum. Timely decisions keep a mission moving, even when conditions are imperfect. Good leadership does not wait forever for perfect clarity.

Analysis matters, but analysis paralysis can kill a build faster than a flawed decision made in time.

BIBLICAL WARNING

James 1:8
A double-minded man is unstable in all his ways.

1 Kings 18:21
Elijah confronts divided loyalty: if the Lord is God, follow Him.

Proverbs 16:9
The heart of man plans his way, but the Lord establishes his steps.

1 Corinthians 14:33
God is not a God of **confusion** but of peace.

Ephesians 5:15–17
Walk wisely, making the best use of the time, and **understand the Lord's will**.

Main takeaway
Decisiveness is not recklessness. It is clear-minded commitment after honest discernment, without instability or the kind of divided posture that breeds disorder among brothers.

Accountability Owns the Outcome

Real leadership refuses excuses, rejects scapegoats, and tells the truth about what happened.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

Accountability means owning the miss, naming the system failure, and bearing the weight of correction. Leaders earn trust when they take responsibility before they claim credit. Their word becomes believable because it is anchored in honesty.

A leader who can say, “I was wrong,” builds more credibility than one who always tries to look right.

VERSES

Matthew 5:37
Let what you say be simply “Yes” or “No.”

Proverbs 27:23
Know the condition of your flocks and pay careful attention to what is under your care.

James 5:16
Confess your sins to one another and pray for one another.

1 Corinthians 4:2
It is required of stewards that they be found **faithful**.

Main takeaway
Ownership is not weakness. It is the moral strength to carry reality without distortion.

Emotional Intelligence Guards Relationships

SELF-AWARENESS

Leaders must know their own triggers, blind spots, and patterns. Men who cannot read themselves usually misread everyone else too.

James 1:19
Be quick to hear, slow to speak, and slow to anger.

Galatians 5:22–23
The fruit of the Spirit includes self-control, patience, and gentleness.

> Leadership is not only direction. It is the stewardship of people.

Emotional intelligence helps a leader read the room, understand what motivates men differently, and choose a tone that brings clarity instead of unnecessary heat.

RELATIONAL IMPACT

Empathy is not softness. It is the disciplined ability to respond in a way that protects the mission and the relationship at the same time.

Proverbs 15:1
A soft answer turns away wrath, but harsh words stir up anger.

Colossians 4:6
Let your speech always be **gracious**, seasoned with salt.

Philippians 2:4
Look not only to your own interests, but also to the **interests of others**.

Resilience Stands Back Up

Setbacks do not disqualify a leader. They reveal whether he can rise again.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

Plans fall apart. Pressure increases. Deadlines move. A resilient leader becomes the calm in the storm. He keeps his footing, regains momentum, and helps the people around him recover instead of collapse.

Resilience is not pretending nothing happened. It is absorbing the hit without surrendering the mission.

VERSES

Proverbs 24:16
The righteous fall seven times and rise again.

2 Corinthians 4:8–9
We are afflicted in every way, but **not crushed**; struck down, but not destroyed.

Galatians 6:9
Do not grow weary of doing good, for in due season we will **reap**.

Main takeaway
The leader's steadiness in crisis often becomes the team's stability.

Integrity Makes Leadership Credible

Leadership gains influence through trust, and trust is built through character.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

Men will not fully follow a leader whose private life and public words do not agree. Integrity means doing what is right even when it is inconvenient, expensive, or invisible to everyone else. It keeps authority from becoming manipulation.

VERSES AND TAKEAWAY

Proverbs 10:9
Whoever walks in integrity walks securely.

1 Timothy 3:2
An overseer must be **above reproach**.

Titus 2:7–8
Show yourself in all respects to be a model of good works, with **integrity and dignity**.

A leader's word becomes weighty when others know he pays the same price in secret that he asks from others in public.

Delegation Multiplies the Mission

A boss controls people. A leader develops people and entrusts real responsibility.

Delegation is not a way to avoid work. It is how leadership scales the mission, prevents burnout, and trains the next generation of able men to carry meaningful weight.

BIBLICAL PATTERN

Exodus 18:21
Jethro tells Moses to appoint able men over groups of thousands, hundreds, fifties, and tens.

Ecclesiastes 4:12
Though one may be overpowered, two can defend themselves. A cord of three strands is not quickly broken.

Ephesians 4:11–12
Leaders are given to **equip the saints** for the work of ministry.

1 Corinthians 12:7
To each is given the manifestation of the Spirit for the **common good**.

The point is not mere efficiency. It is shared strength. Authority entrusted wisely creates health in both the mission and the men carrying it.

When leadership gives others room to own real tasks, the work expands, strength is reinforced, and future leaders are formed in the process.

Humility Knows Who You Are

Humility is not thinking less of yourself. It is seeing yourself accurately before God.

A humble man knows both sides of the truth: he has a calling, and he is not self-sustaining. He can stand confidently in his assignment while also knowing that without Christ he has no life, breath, or lasting strength.

LEADERSHIP PRINCIPLE

Humility keeps identity from drifting into pride and keeps dependence from collapsing into insecurity. It is strong because it is honest about both gift and weakness.

Philippians 2:3
Do nothing from selfish ambition, but in humility count others more significant than yourselves.

Romans 12:3
Think with **sober judgment**, according to the measure of faith God has assigned.

1 Corinthians 15:10
By the grace of God **I am what I am**.

The humble leader knows who he is, but he also knows who he is not.

A Humble Walk Stays Teachable

Humility becomes visible in how a man walks, talks, and treats people he could easily overlook.

LEADERSHIP POSTURE

A humble man is approachable. He is not puffed up, and he is not collapsed into false weakness. He stays teachable, grounded, and near to other people.

VERSES

Micah 6:8
Do justice, love mercy, and walk humbly with your God.

Philippians 2:5
Have this **mind among yourselves**, which is yours in Christ Jesus.

James 1:21
Receive with **meekness** the implanted word.

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

Justice — ethics, fairness, and right dealing.

Mercy — empathy, second chances, and support for others.

Humility — low ego, teachability, and refusing to look down on people.

WEEK 1 CLOSING FRAMEWORK

The Leadership Grid

Justice

Ethics, integrity, and fair dealing in every sphere of responsibility.

James 3:17
Wisdom from above is **impartial** and full of good fruit.

Mercy

Empathy, patience, and the willingness to restore rather than discard people.

Luke 6:36
Be **merciful**, even as your Father is merciful.

Humility

Teachability, low ego, and an approachability that stays near to others.

1 Peter 5:5
Clothe yourselves with **humility** toward one another.

Closing insight: Strong leadership is not measured only by force. It is revealed by how a man handles power, people, and posture under God.